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Courtesy: Ministry of Foreign Affairs

■ UAE's multifaceted aid reaches Gaza by land, sea, and air as it resumes Birds of Goodness airdrop missions, alongside the land-based aid deliveries via the Rafah border crossing.

UAE leads humanitarian and medical aid campaign for Gaza

38 more Emirati aid trucks roll into Strip following 25 trucks that entered Sunday

ABU DHABI
BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

A convoy of Emirati humanitarian aid trucks entered the Gaza Strip yesterday through the Rafah border crossing, as part of the UAE's ongoing efforts to support and provide relief to the Palestinian people under the Operation Chivalrous Knight 3 humanitarian mission.

The convoy consisted of 38 trucks, including 18 loaded with food supplies, medical aid, and infant formula, and 20 trucks carrying pipes, tanks, and equipment to support the operation of a new water pipeline.

This pipeline will stretch approximately 7 kilometres, connecting the UAE-established desalination plant in Egypt to the displacement zones between the Palestinian cities of Rafah and Khan Younis, with a production capacity of 2 million gallons per day.

An earlier convoy of 25

600,000

Gazans to get 15 litres of desalinated water per person per day

trucks had entered on Sunday, carrying water pipes and essential equipment for the pipeline. This brings the total number of trucks transporting materials for the water infrastructure project to 45, with all necessary components now delivered and preparations underway for the project's implementation.

Water project

On May 15, the UAE announced the launch of the humanitarian water project under Operation Gallant Knight 3 to supply desalinated water from Egypt to southern Gaza via a new and unprecedented pipeline, aimed at addressing the severe water crisis in the region.

This project aims to serve approximately 600,000 residents, providing 15 litres of desalinated water per person per day, in light of the destruction of over 80 per cent

of water facilities in Gaza due to the ongoing conflict.

The UAE also resumed its Birds of Goodness airdrop missions on Sunday, alongside the continued land-based aid deliveries via the Rafah border crossing. These efforts reflect the UAE's steadfast commitment to alleviating the humanitarian crisis in Gaza and standing in solidarity with the Palestinian people.

Medical support

In the field of medical and health support, the UAE established a 200-bed field hospital in Rafah, southern Gaza, which has treated tens of thousands of patients. The hospital is equipped with advanced surgical suites capable of performing a variety of procedures, including general surgery, paediatric surgery, and vascular surgery.

Additionally, the UAE Floating Hospital in Arish, Egypt, has provided medical care to thousands of Gaza residents. Officially launched on February 24, 2024, the hospital became a symbol of UAE solidarity with the Palestinian people, offering 24/7 integrated health care to patients and the wounded.

— with inputs from WAM
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UAE banks to raise overseas card use fees

FEES ON OVERSEAS CARD PURCHASES WILL CLIMB TO 3.14% FROM 2.09%

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor
JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Local banks in the UAE have notified their customers that starting September 22 this year, fees on international transactions made with credit cards or debit cards will be increased, *Al Khaleej* Arabic daily reported.

In a notice circulated to clients by one of the banks, the surcharge for using cards abroad will rise to 3.14 per cent of the transaction amount, up from the current 2.09 per cent.

Banking sources said that lenders across the country are re-evaluating the fees imposed on various banking services. Such fees, they noted, are typically adjusted — whether upward or downward — in line with operational requirements and broader cost structures.

More expensive travel

The notice effectively means that travelling internationally is about to get more expensive for UAE residents — at least when it comes to card payments.

The steep increase could quietly inflate your travel budget if you're not prepared.

UAE banks' new 3.14 per cent surcharge on international transactions applies whether

These fees can hit even if you're charged in USD, not just in euros, pounds, or yen. That's because what matters is where and how the transaction is processed — not just the currency.

you're spending at a hotel in Paris, shopping online with a US-based website, or withdrawing cash from an ATM in Singapore.

The fee is typically broken down into:

■ 1 per cent currency conversion fee from Visa, Mastercard, or Amex.

■ 2.14 per cent transaction fee charged by your bank or card issuer.

This means even a modest Dh5,000 overseas spend could cost an extra Dh157 in fees alone.

These fees can hit even if you're charged in USD, not just in euros, pounds, or yen. That's because what matters is where and how the transaction is processed — not just the currency.

Rising foreign transaction fees mean UAE residents need to travel smarter. A little planning — such as choosing the right card, avoiding DCC (Dynamic Currency Conversion), and withdrawing cash wisely — can save hundreds of dirhams per trip.



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19-year-old beats Koneru Humpy in all-Indian final | P13

Dubai malls, restaurants to offer dishes for Dh10

Mouthwatering deal part of DSS campaign

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

UAE residents and visitors can enjoy a new culinary highlight during this year's Dubai Summer Surprises (DSS), with Dh10 meals being offered at hundreds of outlets across the city throughout August.

Launching for the first time as a summer edition, the 'DSS 10 Dirham Dish' campaign will run from August 1 to 31, giving residents and visitors the chance to sample a wide range of flavours from over 190 restaurants across more than 700 locations, including malls, cafés, and casual dining spots.



Organised by Dubai Festivals and Retail Establishment (DFRE), the DSS 10 Dirham Dish spans two key DSS retail seasons — the final week of the Great Dubai Summer Sale (until August 10) and the Back-to-School season (August 11–31).

The line-up of offerings includes everything from burgers and bao to ice cream and regional street food.

A full list of participating outlets and dishes is available at www.mydss.ae.

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